

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by



Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

TRANSPORTATION



Elon Musk's Boring Company to build Tesla tunnels under Nashville

The Boring Company, Elon Musk's tunnel-digging company, and Tennessee Governor Bill Lee have announced a plan to build a 10-mile "loop" that will connect Nashville's downtown and its convention center.

The project is being led by the Boring Company, the Governor's office, and the local economic development authority. Initial funding is being provided by the state.

Construction is expected to start in the fall of 2025, and the tunnel is expected to be operational as "early as fall of 2026."

If that happens, Nashville would become the second city where The Boring Company has opened such a system, with the first being Las Vegas. The company has spent the last few years in Sin City digging and opening tunnels around the Las Vegas Convention Center, and claims to have given 3 million rides in Teslas to date.

Musk launched The Boring Company in early 2017 (after publicly noodling about the idea on Twitter while stuck in traffic in late 2016), and it has taken many forms since then.

TEC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech

s of
park
vation
before

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want transportation news.

government's website

- Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'
- Google says hackers stole its customers' data by breaching its Salesforce database
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Spotify raises subscription prices

The original video detailing Musk’s idea — now set to private on YouTube — showed vehicles getting removed from surface street gridlock by an elevator-meets-sled system and lowered into a three-dimensional underground network of tunnels. Musk also claimed during the first Trump administration that The Boring Company had received “verbal govt approval” to dig tunnels from New York City to Washington, D.C. that, leveraging hyperloop technology, could make the trip in just 29 minutes.

None of that ever happened. The Boring Company abandoned plans to dig a major tunnel system underneath the greater Los Angeles area after

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

The idea
biograp
Californ
aside. B
tunnels
Musk’s

Instead
resemb

mover, although there are some potential benefits to its approach versus the typical monorail setup. Construction should be less disruptive to Nashville’s daily traffic. And, in its current form at least, it’s not costing taxpayers money.

While the Tennessee governor’s office cites The Boring Company’s safety record in Las Vegas in the announcement — the loop “recently earned a 99.57% safety and security rating” from the Department of Homeland Security and Transportation Security Administration, according to the press release — it is careful not to mention the trouble that Musk’s tunnel-digging effort has

- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

experienced during construction. (The governor's office could not be reached for comment.)

Like with [other Musk companies](#), the pace at which The Boring Company operates — the same speed that the Tennessee governor's office praised in its announcement — has been a concern for some of its workers.

Last year, Fortune's Jessica Mathews [reported](#) that a Boring Company employee told his then-safety manager: "I have watched my friends get injured due to the fast pace we've been running... I refuse to be the first fatality in this company's history. No tunnel is worth a single person's life."

That said, on the road, he told to visitors he couldn't

Topics:

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [📧](#) [✉](#)



Sean O'Kane

Sr. Reporter, Transportation | [X](#)

Sean O'Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology o...

[View Bio](#) >

———— KEEP READING ————

TRANSPORTATION



Tesla shuts down Dojo, the AI training supercomputer that

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

Tesla is breaking up the team behind its [Dojo supercomputer](#), ending the automaker's play at developing in-house chips for driverless technology, according to [Bloomberg](#).

Dojo's lead, Peter Bannon, is leaving the company, and the remaining team members will be reassigned to other data center and compute projects within Tesla, per Bloomberg's reporting, which cited anonymous sources.

The disbanding of Tesla's Dojo efforts follows the departure of around 20 workers, who left the automaker to start their own [AI company called](#)

Newsletters

[See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry's biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch's coverage.

[DensityAI](#). The new startup is reportedly coming out of stealth soon and is building chips, hardware, and software that will power data centers for AI that are used in robotics, by AI agents, and in automotive applications. DensityAI was founded by former Dojo head [Ganesh Venkataramanan](#) and ex-Tesla employees Bill Chang and Ben Floering.

It also comes at a crucial time for Tesla.

[CEO Elon Musk has pushed](#) to get shareholders to view Tesla as an AI and robotics company, despite a limited robotaxi launch in Austin this past June that featured Model Y vehicles with a bumper in the front.

Latest

Security

Startups Weekly

Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review

Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility

TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

\$600 billion to the company's market value by unlocking new revenue streams in the form of robotaxis and software services. Just last year, Musk noted that Tesla's AI team would "[double down](#)" on Dojo in the lead-up to [Tesla's robotaxi reveal](#), which happened in October.

TC

Techcrunch event

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here

to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

REGISTER

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want transportation news.

But talk when M
“giant m
Tesla H

The Dojo part in-house chip-making. Tesla unveiled its D1 chip when it formally announced Dojo at its first AI Day in 2021. [Venkataramanan](#) presented the chip, which Tesla said would be used alongside Nvidia's GPU to power the Dojo supercomputer. The automaker also said it was working on a next-gen D2 chip that would solve any information flow bottlenecks of its predecessor.

Sources told Bloomberg that now Tesla plans to increase its reliance on Nvidia, as well as other external tech partners like AMD for compute and Samsung for chip manufacturing. Tesla last month signed a [\\$16.5 billion deal with Samsung](#) to make

its AI6 inference chips, a chip design that promises to scale from powering FSD and Tesla's Optimus humanoid robots all the way to high-performance AI training in data centers.

During Tesla's second-quarter earnings call, Musk hinted at potential redundancies.

"Thinking about Dojo 3 and the AI6 inference chip, it seems like intuitively, we want to try to find convergence there, where it's basically the same chip," Musk said.

The news comes as [Tesla's board offers Musk a \\$29 billion pay package](#) to keep him at Tesla and help

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

TechCrunch provides the latest news, information, and analysis on the tech industry.

Have a story tip?

We're not just

industry

the people

to Rebe

rebecca

at maxwell.zen@techcrunch.com. For secure

communication, you can contact us via Signal at

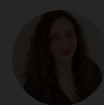
[@rebeccabellan.491](#) and [@mzeff.88](#).

Topics: [AI](#) [autonomous vehicles](#) [Dojo](#) [Elon Musk](#)

[robotaxis](#) [Tesla](#) [Transportation](#)



[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [g+](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)



Rebecca Korosec
she co

View B

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want transportation news.

TRANSPORTATION

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [g+](#) [✉](#) [🔗](#)

Federal regulators give
Zoox an exemption for its
custom-built robotaxis

The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration has given Zoox an exemption to demonstrate its custom-built robotaxis on public roads and closed a related investigation into whether the Amazon-

Latest in Transportation

See More

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want transportation news.

The investigation didn't slow Zoox's development and testing of its autonomous vehicle technology. In early 2023, Zoox began [testing its custom-built robotaxis](#), which don't have a steering wheel or other traditional controls, on public roads near its Foster City, California headquarters. The company has since expanded its testing footprint to [Las Vegas and San Francisco](#).

Zoos does not operate a commercial service yet. However, in San Francisco it has opened its robotaxis up to employees and hosted family and friends. Earlier this year, the company launched an

in India

Jagmeet Singh - 3 days ago

Zoox Explorer program, aimed at early public riders, in Las Vegas.

For now, the exemption allows Zoox to demonstrate the robotaxis, not operate them commercially.

NHTSA's announcement is connected to its [new national framework](#), which the agency argues will make it easier for companies to deploy autonomous vehicles without traditional manual driving controls — like steering wheels, pedals, and sideview mirrors — at scale.

The framework allows NHTSA to green-light the sale and commercialization of autonomous vehicles that are due to a

TC
TechCr
Tech and
agenda

Netflix
Elad G
joining
to deliv
growth
the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt,
and a chance to learn from the top voices in
tech — grab your ticket now and save up to
\$600+ before prices rise.

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech —

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want transportation news.](#)

grab your ticket now and save up to \$675
before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

The revised process involves an expedited application that allows companies like Zoox to receive exemptions for testing and demonstrations, and eventually, commercial operations. Zoox spokesperson Whitney Jencks said in an email that Zoox is working in close cooperation with NHTSA on this process, beginning with the demonstration exemption and followed by the commercial exemption.

As part of the investigation, NHTSA is looking at whether Zoox has the resources and expertise to ensure that its autonomous vehicles are safe for public application.

Topics:

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want transportation news.



Kirsten Korosec

Transportation Editor |

Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous...

View Bio >

Loading the next article



[TechCrunch](#)[Staff](#)[Contact Us](#)[Advertise](#)[Crunchboard
Jobs](#)[Site Map](#)[Terms of
Service](#)[Privacy
Policy](#)[RSS Terms of
Use](#)[OpenAI](#)[Perplexity](#)[Cisco](#)[DeepMind](#)[Windsurf](#)[Tech Layoffs](#)[ChatGPT](#)

© 2025 TechCrunch Media LLC.

Don't let our best transportation reporting pass you by

Get weekly updates from Kirsten Korosec and her team about innovation, automation, and more.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want transportation news.